

Seabird Monitoring Report – Q2 2026

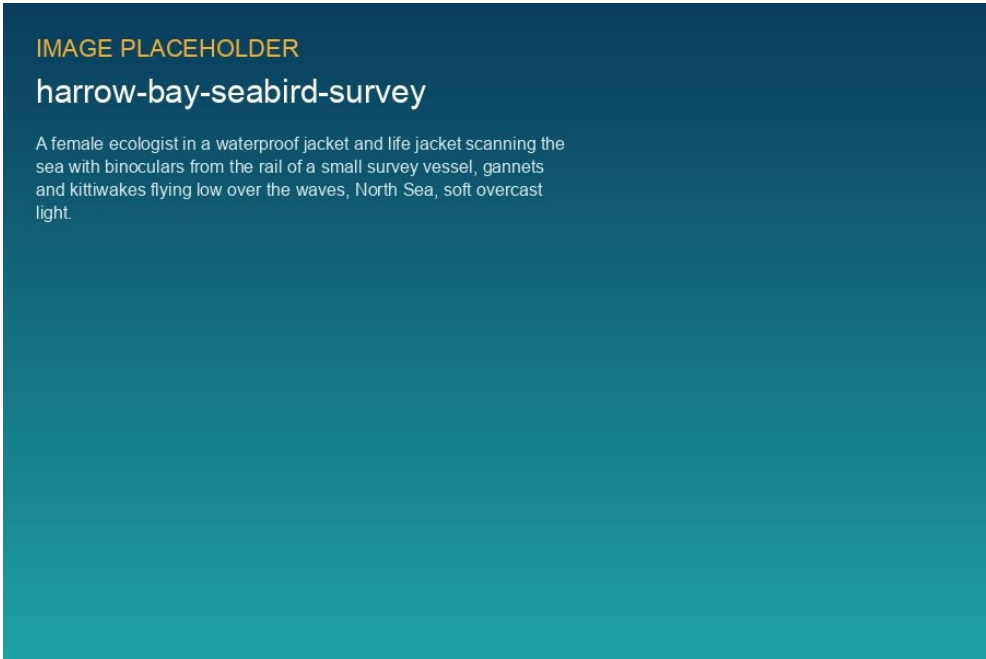
Harrow Bay Offshore Wind · digital aerial surveys

Elena Márquez · 17 July 2026 · MAR-HB-SB-2026-Q2

Prepared for Weyland Energy by Marlow Ecology Ltd. Lead author: Dr. Rachel Moss. Report MAR-HB-SB-2026-Q2.

1. Summary

Three digital aerial surveys were flown in April, May and June 2026, covering the array area plus a 4 km buffer (412 km²). Abundance of all key species was within the range of the 24-month pre-construction baseline. Black-legged kittiwake and northern gannet numbers peaked in June, in line with the breeding season at the colonies 45–60 km to the north-west. There is no evidence so far of displacement beyond the levels assumed in the Environmental Statement.



Boat-based validation survey, May 2026

2. Results

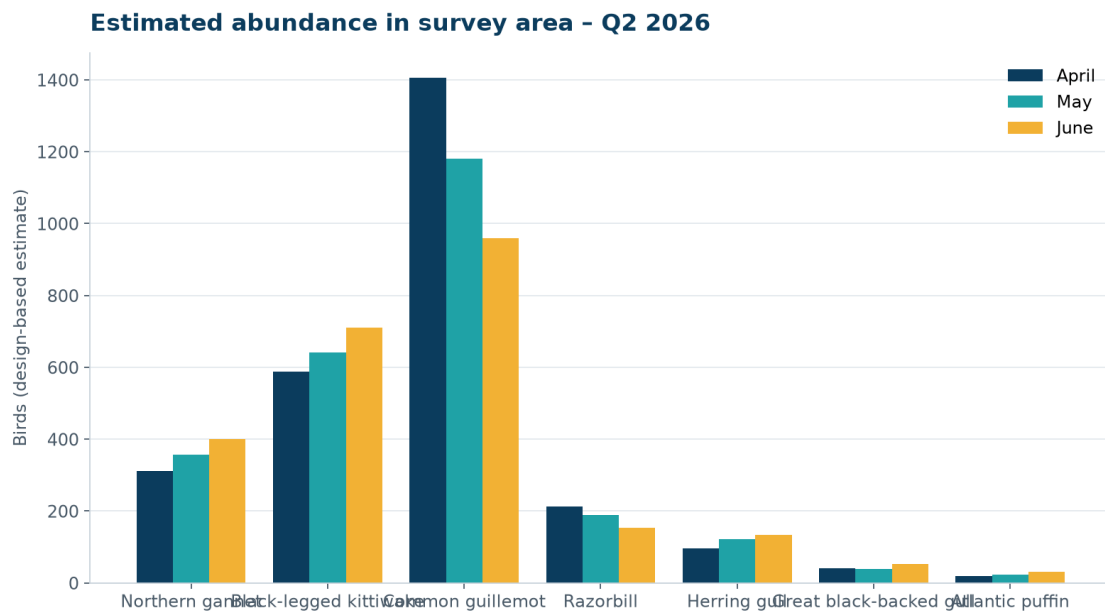


Figure 1 – Design-based abundance estimates per survey

Species	April	May	June	Baseline range (Q2)
Northern gannet	312	356	401	240 – 450
Black-legged kittiwake	588	642	711	480 – 820
Common guillemot	1405	1180	960	900 – 1,700
Razorbill	212	188	154	130 – 300
Herring gull	96	121	133	70 – 160
Great black-backed gull	41	38	52	25 – 70
Atlantic puffin	18	22	31	10 – 45

3. Displacement analysis

Densities of common guillemot inside the array were 22 % lower than in the 4 km buffer during the survey after the pile installation at HB-A06 (12 May), compared with 9 % in the baseline. The effect was no longer detectable in the June survey. Kittiwake showed no significant difference between array and buffer.

4. Recommendations

- Continue monthly surveys through the construction phase (condition 13).
- Add a dedicated survey within 48 hours after a piling day to quantify short-term displacement of auks.
- Share data with the regional seabird monitoring programme as agreed with the regulator.